

PunkBackup — Installation Manual

> This manual shows the app in **English**. It opens in Spanish by default the very first time — go to **"Settings"** → **"English"** and everything switches instantly (no restart). Your choice is remembered after that.

What this system does

Automatically backs up photos and videos from one or more iPhones/iPads to your Windows PC, over local WiFi or by cable, no iCloud dependency. Each person/device gets its own profile with its own destination folder.

Important: this app is not code-signed

PunkBackup is a small independent project — the `.exe` is **not** digitally signed with a paid code-signing certificate (those cost money; see the project's notes on this if you're curious why). This has two real, expected consequences:

- **Windows SmartScreen** will warn you once at install time (see Step 2). This is normal and harmless — click through it as described below.
- **Your antivirus may go further than a warning.** Antivirus products use heuristics (behavior patterns), not just known-virus lists, and an unsigned new program that talks to the network can trip those heuristics — even though PunkBackup only talks to your own iPhone on your own WiFi and never sends anything anywhere else. **Avast in particular has been observed silently closing PunkBackup shortly after it opens**, with no error message from the app itself (it just vanishes). If that happens to you, it's Avast, not a bug in PunkBackup — see the fix below.

> **What this actually looks like in practice, and why it can be confusing**: Avast doesn't block PunkBackup from opening at all — it lets it open normally, scans it *while it's already running* (so everything looks fine for those first several seconds), and only then silently closes it and reopens it on its own, roughly **10 seconds** after the first launch. From your side, it looks like the app just vanished and came back for no reason — that's Avast's scan cycle, not PunkBackup crashing. The app's own automatic retry (see the Troubleshooting Manual, "The iPhone can't reach the server") already handles the server coming back up cleanly after this happens.

> **The one real consequence to know about**: if you start a backup from your iPhone during that first ~10-second window — before Avast's close-and-reopen cycle finishes — that specific backup run gets cut off right at the moment Avast closes the app, and needs to be started again from the iPhone once

> PunkBackup is back and stable. Nothing is lost or corrupted (any file already fully uploaded before that moment stays backed up permanently), but that particular run won't finish on its own. **The fix below (an Avast exception) makes this stop happening entirely** — once PunkBackup is excluded from scanning, it just opens normally like any other program, with no 10-second window at all.

You can read the full source code yourself (this is an open-source project) if you want to verify exactly what it does before trusting it.

Fixing "Avast keeps closing the app"

1. Open **Avast** → **Menu** → **Quarantine** (or "Virus Chest") — if `PunkBackup.exe` is listed there, restore it and add an exception so it doesn't get grabbed again.
2. Or: **Avast** → **Menu** → **Settings** → **General** → **Exceptions** → add the install folder (default `C:\Program Files\PunkBackup\`) so Avast skips scanning/blocking it entirely.
3. Reopen PunkBackup from the Desktop icon — it should now stay open.

This is the same fix for other antivirus products that behave this way (Windows Defender, Norton, etc.) — add an exception for the PunkBackup install folder.

Requirements

- **Windows 10 or 11** PC.
- **Internet** connection (only to download the installer).
- The iPhone/iPad and the PC must be able to reach the **same WiFi network** at backup time.
- **Administrator** rights on the PC (asked once, during install — to copy the program and add the Firewall rule).

Step 1 — Download the installer

Download `PunkBackupSetup.exe` from the project's release page:

https://github.com/hesner/punkbackup/releases/latest

Step 2 — Run the installer

1. Double-click `PunkBackupSetup.exe`.
2. Windows may show a **SmartScreen** warning ("Windows protected your PC") since this is a new program without a paid code-signing certificate — click **"More info"** → **"Run anyway"**.
3. Accept the **User Account Control (UAC)** prompt — the installer needs admin rights to copy the program into `Program Files` and to add the Firewall rule.
4. If your antivirus scans the file (e.g. Avast, "Suspicious file detected" / reputation scan), that's normal for a brand-new installer — let it finish, it shouldn't find anything.

5. Follow the wizard: - Pick the setup language (this does **not** set the app's language — the app has its own ES/EN switch in "Settings"). - Keep **"Create a desktop icon"** checked to get the Desktop shortcut. - Keep the **Firewall rule** task checked (recommended — if you skip it, you'll need to add it manually later for your iPhone to connect). - Click **Install** and wait for it to finish.
6. At the end, leave "Launch PunkBackup" checked and click **Finish** — the app opens on its own.

Step 3 — First launch

1. The app opens (dark window, two screens: "Main" and "Settings"), in Spanish by default — switch it to English per the note at the top of this manual, if you haven't already.
2. Go to **"Settings"** → click **"+ Add profile"** → name your device (e.g. "iPhone de [your name]") → pick the folder where you want your photos saved.
3. Go to **"Main"** → click **"Start backup"**.
   If you didn't check the Firewall task during install, Windows may show the prompt here instead asking to allow the connection — accept it, checking at least **"Private networks"**.

> **Don't assume you're fine just because no prompt showed up.** Some PCs have Windows' "notify me when Firewall blocks a new app" setting turned off (common on work/managed PCs), or the network is set to "Public" instead of "Private" — in either case Windows can block the connection silently, with no popup at all. If your iPhone can't reach the server later and you never saw this prompt, go straight to the **Troubleshooting Manual**'s "The iPhone can't reach the server" section and check/add the Firewall rule manually — don't assume the rule exists just because installation finished without errors.

5. It should say **"Status: Listening on port 8787 "**.

Step 4 — Set up your iPhone

Follow the separate **iPhone Setup Manual** to create the Shortcut and, optionally, the WiFi automation.

Is it working?

- Check **"Settings"** shows your profile with its destination folder.
- Run the Shortcut once on your iPhone as a test.
- Check the folder you chose — you should see Year/Month subfolders with your photos inside.

If something's not working, see the **Troubleshooting Manual**.

To use backup by cable (optional)

You only need the iPhone's cable. If Windows doesn't recognize the phone, install **Apple Devices** from the Microsoft Store. The first time, unlock the iPhone and tap **Trust**. Backup by cable doesn't use the network or the Firewall rule. See the **Usage Manual**.